Verb forms: the present tense

- The present tense is used to describe:
  - **What you are doing** *(I am eating)*
  - **What you normally do** *(I eat)*
  - **What you have been doing/have done for some time** *(I have been eating for…. I have eaten for…)*

- Only the context tells you whether *je mange* means *I eat* or *I am eating*. **Never attempt to say anything like** ~~*je suis mangeant*~~.

- Regular verbs follow the following pattern:

	passer	*to pass*		**choisir**	*to choose*		**vendre**	*to sell*
je	*pass*	**e**	*je*	*chois*	**is**	*je*	*vend*	**s**
tu	*pass*	**es**	*tu*	*chois*	**is**	*tu*	*vend*	**s**
il/elle	*pass*	**e**	*il/elle*	*chois*	**it**	*il/elle*	*vend*	**-**
nous	*pass*	**ons**	*nous*	*chois*	**issons**	*nous*	*vend*	**ons**
vous	*pass*	**ez**	*vous*	*chois*	**issez**	*vous*	*vend*	**ez**
ils/elles	*pass*	**ent**	*ils/elles*	*chois*	**issent**	*ils/elles*	*vend*	**ent**

- Verbs ending in -GER, -CER, -YER and -E/É-consonant-ER have stem changes in the present tense and these should be revised from F.

- Irregular -IR verbs should be revised
- Irregular -OIR verbs should be revised
- Irregular - RE verbs should be revised
- Irregular -IRE verbs should be revised

Verb forms: the future tense

- The future tense is used to describe:
  - **What you will be doing** *(I will be eating)*
  - **What you will do** *(I will eat)*

- To form the future tense, simply:
  - Take the infinitive (removing the final E of –RE verbs) manger, finir, vendre
  - Add the correct personal ending: (rather like "AVOIR" in the present tense)

    je PARLER – **ai**
    tu FINIR – **as**
    il/elle VENDR – **a**
    nous RÉUSSIR – **ons**
    vous RENCONTRER – **ez**
    ils RENDR – **ont**

- As usual, there are some frequently used **irregular stems** to learn:

avoir	**j'aur ai**
aller	**j'ir ai**
être	**je ser ai**

vouloir	**je voudr ai**
mourir	**je mourr ai**
pouvoir	**je pourr ai**
courir	**je courr ai**
savoir	**je saur ai**
s'asseoir	**je m'assiér ai**
il faut	**il faudr a**
il pleut	**il pleuvr a**

voir	**je verr ai**
envoyer	**j'enverr ai**
recevoir	**je recevr ai**
devoir	**je devr ai**
faire	**je fer ai**
venir	**je viendr ai**
tenir	**je tiendr ai**

- The spelling changes which take place for *certain* persons in the present tense, take place for **ALL** persons in the future tense. See E Mich 3.

Verb forms: the imperfect tense

- The imperfect tense is used to describe:
  - **What you were doing** *(I was eating)*
  - **What you normally did/used to do** *(I ate/I used to eat/I would eat)*
  - **What you had been doing/had done for some time** *(I had been eating for…. I had eaten for…)*

- To form the imperfect tense of any verb (except *ÊTRE* whose stem is *ÉT*), simply:
  - **Find the nous form of the present tense**
  - **Remove the –ONS ending** (nous choisiss~~ons~~, nous sav~~ons~~)
  - You are left with the "stem". **Add the personal ending to the stem**
    1. je CHOISISS – **ais**
    2. tu PARL – **ais**
    3. il/elle MANGE – **ait**
    4. nous SAV – **ions**
    5. vous ACHET – **iez**
    6. ils CONDUIS – **aient**
- See F Lent 7 for fuller details of when to use this tense.

To play: jouer à or jouer de?

- When talking about musical instruments, use **DE**, for sports and games use **À**.

  - *De quels instruments sais-tu jouer? Et à quels sports sais-tu jouer?*
  - *Je joue du piano, de la trompette, au rugby et aux échecs.*
  - *Il joue au Monopoly et aux cartes pour passer le temps.*